

AI Workflow Audit & Foundations

1. Workflow Audit Table

Task	Classification	Rationale
1. Brainstorming architecture for side projects	Collaborate with AI	AI is great at bouncing ideas and suggesting alternatives, but I need to guide the design decisions.
2. Reviewing peer pull requests	Just me	I need to deeply understand the codebase changes and build trust with my team; AI can't replace the human context here.
3. Writing boilerplate code or basic APIs	Delegate to AI with review	AI handles repetitive coding well, but I must review it to ensure it fits the project's exact standards.
4. Attending team standups / classes	Just me	Human connection and real-time empathy are crucial for team dynamics and cannot be outsourced.
5. Drafting initial emails to professors/managers	Delegate to AI with review	AI can quickly structure the email and set a professional tone, saving me staring at a blank page.
6. Debugging obscure error messages	Collaborate with AI	I provide the logs and context; the AI helps me quickly narrow down the root cause.
7. Formatting JSON/CSV data for testing	Fully automate	Trivial, repetitive data formatting is a waste of human time and perfect for AI scripts.
8. Reading technical documentation for new tools	Just me	I need to build my own mental model of how the tool works, not just rely on AI summaries.
9. Writing basic unit tests for existing functions	Delegate to AI with review	AI can generate the test cases instantly, I just need to verify they cover edge cases.
10. Planning weekly study/work schedule	Collaborate with AI	AI can help optimize time blocks, but I need to decide my actual priorities and energy levels.
11. Creating initial project READMEs	Delegate to AI with review	AI is excellent at formatting standard documentation structures based on a brief prompt.
12. Sorting and categorizing personal expenses	Fully automate	AI tools can parse receipts and CSVs to categorize data instantly without my input.

2. Target Tasks for Future Phases

Target Task 1: Debugging obscure error messages

- **Success Definition ("Done Well"):** The AI provides the exact root cause and a working fix within 2 prompts, saving me at least 30 minutes of manual searching, without introducing new bugs.

Target Task 2: Writing boilerplate code or basic APIs

- **Success Definition ("Done Well"):** The AI generates the required functions and routing logic matching my existing codebase conventions (e.g., proper error handling, naming) requiring less than 5 minutes of manual tweaking.

Target Task 3: Brainstorming architecture for side projects

- **Success Definition ("Done Well"):** The AI proposes at least two distinct, viable approaches (e.g., serverless vs. containerized) with clear pros and cons, helping me finalize a decision in under 15 minutes.

3. Claude Project: Custom Instructions Template

Who I am:

I am a software developer and student currently focusing on backend engineering and AI integrations. I value clean code, understanding fundamentals (like the request-response loop), and building practical projects.

Tone Preferences:

Please keep responses concise, technical, and direct. Avoid overly enthusiastic or robotic language. When explaining concepts, use practical code examples rather than abstract theory. Tell me *why* something works, not just *how* to do it.

Current Goals:

My immediate goal is to master AI tooling to automate repetitive coding tasks so I can focus on high-level system design. I am also working through an AI Fluency program to audit and improve my weekly workflows.